Project 3 - LevelUp | Beautify a Website

You've built a strong foundation in CSS. Now it's time to apply it on your own terms.

In this LevelUp project, you'll build on your Fran's Flowers redesign from the walkthrough. You already gave it a much-needed visual refresh using your own code, not AI.

Now, push your design further. Add new features and details that improve the site's look, usability, or brand feel. The rule still stands: no AI writing your code. Explore, research, test things out, and trust your judgment.

Project Steps Overview:

- **Reopen Your Fran's Flowers Redesign:**
  - Return to the project files you built during the walkthrough. You'll be working on top of that code to extend your design.
- **Add a Navigation Bar:**
  - Add a responsive navigation bar that links to the About, Specials, and Visit Us sections of the page.
  - The layout should adapt on smaller screens.
- **Add a Testimonials Section:**
  - Add a new section below the Specials area with at least two customer testimonials.
  - Style each quote with consistent typography, spacing, and alignment.

- **Refine the Footer:** Add extra content to the footer, such as placeholder navigation links and social media icons.
- **Ready for a LevelUp? (15pts extra credit)**
  - **New Page (10 pts):** Create a second "About Fran" page. Link to it from the main nav. Keep it simple and consistent with the main page.
  - **Seasonal Picks (5 pts):** Add a section called "Seasonal Picks" showcasing one featured flower or bouquet. Include a heading, image, a short description, and a fun detail like "Best for birthdays" or "Only here 'til October."
  - **Improve Site Accessibility (10 pts):** Some of Fran's older customers find the site hard to use.
    - Run a Lighthouse accessibility audit in Chrome DevTools to identify issues that might affect visitors. Make adjustments to color contrast, font size, or layout based on the results.
    - Answer the reflection questions to explain any accessibility changes you made.
- **Commit and Push** your project changes to GitHub from Codespaces to prevent losing progress.
- **Test & Deploy:**
  - Use DevTools to check how your page looks at different screen sizes.
  - Deploy your page using GitHub Pages and grab the link for submission.

- Please test your link in an incognito or private browser to ensure it's correctly published and visible to evaluators.

- **Reflect on your experience** and prepare for job interviews and professional networking by answering all the questions below.

1. Paste your website's URL

https://akapil1.github.io/Frank-s_Flowers_EC/

Reminder: When you are sharing your work with evaluators, make sure to share your **Github pages link** and NOT a link to your repository or Codespace. The CORRECT kind of link should look like this:

- https://username.github.io/your-repo-name

1B. Did you do any of the LevelUps? To help the evaluator notice—and give you the bonus points you deserve! Please list them here:

Yes, I completed multiple LevelUp features and added additional enhancements to further improve usability, interactivity, and brand experience:

- I created a dedicated "About Fran" page and linked it from the main navigation. The page maintains the same typography, color palette, and layout style as the homepage to ensure visual consistency. I also added clear call-to-action buttons to guide users back to key sections of the site.
- I added a Seasonal Picks section showcasing a featured bouquet with a heading, image, short description, and a fun detail highlighting its best use or limited availability.

- I also ran a Lighthouse accessibility audit and made improvements such as increasing font sizes, improving color contrast, refining spacing, and simplifying layouts to make the site easier to read and navigate—especially for older users.
- I designed a testimonial carousel instead of static quotes, allowing users to scroll through customer feedback interactively. Each testimonial includes consistent typography, spacing, and subtle overlay effects to improve readability and visual engagement.
- I implemented a responsive navigation bar with a mobile hamburger menu, slide-in navigation, and overlay effects to improve usability on smaller screens.
- I added hover effects, layered overlays, and refined spacing throughout the site to improve visual hierarchy and create a more polished, modern feel.

2. What was the hardest part of styling your page without using AI? How did you get past that moment? Did anything surprise you once you figured it out? **(10 pt)**

(Paste or write your answer below 👇)

The hardest part of styling the page without using AI was figuring out layout and responsiveness, especially making sections look good on both desktop and mobile screens. It was tempting to want a quick answer, but instead I had to slow down and experiment with things like flexbox, grid layouts, and media queries on my own.

I got past that moment by testing one change at a time, using Chrome DevTools to see how my CSS affected the layout in real time, and researching documentation or examples when something didn't work. What surprised me was how small changes—like adjusting padding, line

height, or max-width—made a huge difference in how professional the site looked once I understood what was happening.

3. What did this project teach you about how to redesign a website so it's easier to use and understand? **(10 pt)**

(Paste or write your answer below 👇)

This project taught me that redesigning a website isn't just about making it look prettier—it's about clarity and usability. Simple things like clear navigation, readable text, consistent spacing, and visual hierarchy make the site much easier to understand, especially for users who aren't very tech-savvy.

I also learned that accessibility plays a big role in usability. Making text larger, improving contrast, and spacing out content doesn't just help people with disabilities—it improves the experience for everyone. A good redesign removes friction and helps users find what they need quickly and comfortably.

4. Imagine you're showing this project to a small business owner like Fran. What would you want them to notice about your design choices? What kind of feedback from her would tell you the redesign is doing its job? **(10 pt)**

(Paste or write your answer below 👇)

If I were showing this project to a small business owner like Fran, I'd want her to notice how the design feels warm, welcoming, and personal, just like a neighborhood flower shop. I'd want her to see that the site highlights her story, makes it easy for customers to explore offerings, and works smoothly on phones as well as computers.

The best feedback from her would be something like:
"This feels like my shop," or
"I think my customers would find this easy to use."

If she felt proud sharing the site with customers and confident that it represents her business clearly, that would tell me the redesign is doing its job.

— Save and submit your work!

Great work completing this Project! To submit your work, download / export this document as a PDF and then upload it to the Project submission page on HQ. You can find the option to download as a PDF from the File menu in the upper-left corner of the Google Doc interface.